Project Report: Back-to-School Bamenda 2024

Field	Details
Reference	ADA/2024/003
Project Title	Back-to-School Drive — Bamenda 2024
Location	Bamenda, North-West Region, Cameroon
Period	September 1–30, 2024
Budget	$1,200 USD (~720,000 CFA)
Actual Spend	$1,183 USD (~710,000 CFA)
Beneficiaries	15 children (ages 3–12)
Status	Completed

1. Executive Summary

ADA successfully conducted its second annual back-to-school drive in Bamenda, North-West Region, serving 15 young children aged 3–12 affected by the Anglophone crisis. Each child received a matching navy blue school backpack branded with their school's logo, a full set of textbooks, exercise books, and stationery, along with a school fees contribution. The distribution event was held in a community building and included a prayer and worship session. The project was delivered under budget at 710,000 CFA ($1,183).

2. Context

The Anglophone crisis continues to devastate communities in Cameroon's North-West Region. Many families in Bamenda have been displaced, and the economic impact has left parents unable to afford school supplies or fees for their children. Some beneficiaries — children as young as 3 years old — had never attended school before this intervention.

This was ADA's second year operating a back-to-school program in Bamenda, building on relationships established in the previous year.

3. Activities Completed

3.1 Beneficiary Selection

- Identified 15 children from crisis-affected families in Bamenda
- Age range: 3–12 years old
- All from families displaced or economically impacted by the Anglophone crisis

3.2 Procurement

- 15 matching navy blue school backpacks, branded with respective school logos
- 15 complete textbook sets appropriate to each child's grade level
- 150 exercise books (10 per child)
- 15 stationery kits (pens, pencils, rulers, erasers)

3.3 Distribution Event

- **Venue:** Unfinished community building (cinder block walls, dirt floor)
- **Team:** 4 ADA volunteers + 1 local coordinator
- **Program:** Prayer/worship session followed by supply distribution
- All 15 children received their complete kits during the event

3.4 School Fees

- School fees contributions paid for all 15 beneficiaries (15,000 CFA each)

4. Outcomes Achieved

Indicator	Target	Achieved
Children receiving backpacks	15	15 ✓
Children receiving full supply kits	15	15 ✓
School fees contributions made	15	15 ✓
Distribution event held	1	1 ✓

Key Achievements

- **100% delivery rate** — all 15 targeted children received complete kits
- **First expansion** to Bamenda for ADA's back-to-school program
- **Youngest beneficiaries served** — children as young as 3 included
- **Under budget** — delivered at 710,000 CFA vs. 720,000 CFA budgeted (savings: 10,000 CFA)
- **Community engagement** — use of local community building as venue strengthened ties

5. Challenges

Challenge	Mitigation
Venue was an unfinished building (no flooring, exposed walls)	Team prepared space as best as possible; children and families were understanding
Very young beneficiaries (age 3) requiring age-appropriate materials	Sourced pre-school level materials for youngest children
Transport logistics (Buea to Bamenda)	Coordinated team travel in advance

6. Lessons Learned

1. **Community buildings work as venues** — even unfinished structures provide adequate space for distribution events when formal venues are unavailable.
2. **Very young children can be served** — including 3-year-olds requires extra planning for age-appropriate materials but is feasible and impactful.
3. **Branded backpacks create identity** — matching backpacks with school logos gave children a sense of belonging and pride.
4. **Local coordinator is essential** — having someone on the ground in Bamenda was critical for beneficiary identification and logistics.

7. Financial Summary

	Budgeted	Actual	Variance
Total (CFA)	720,000	710,000	-10,000
Total (USD)	$1,200	$1,183	-$17

Project delivered **under budget** by 10,000 CFA ($17). See `financial.md` for detailed breakdown.

8. Recommendations

1. Continue annual back-to-school drive in Bamenda for 2025.
2. Increase beneficiary count if funding allows.
3. Explore partnerships with local schools for venue access.
4. Consider follow-up visits to track school attendance of beneficiaries.

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